



FREE HOME-WATCH GUIDE · COLUMBIA PROPERTIES

The Snowbird Home-Prep Checklist

Leaving Your Arizona Home for the Season

Print this and check off each item before you head out. A little prep now prevents the expensive surprises that happen to homes sitting empty in the Arizona heat.

Before you leave

- ☐ Shut off the main water supply (or individual valves). A burst line in an empty house is the single most common catastrophic claim.
- ☐ Set HVAC to a safe "away" temperature, don't switch it off entirely. Arizona heat and humidity invite mold and heat damage.
- ☐ Have the pool/spa serviced and set on a schedule, and arrange ongoing service while you're gone.
- ☐ Get a pest-control treatment before you go. Scorpions, rodents, and ants move in quickly on a quiet house.
- ☐ Check smoke and CO detector batteries; unplug non-essential electronics.
- ☐ Secure all doors, windows, and the garage; put a few interior lights on timers.
- ☐ Pause mail and package delivery, or arrange pickup. A piled-up porch advertises an empty home.
- ☐ Leave a key and your contact info with a trusted local, or a home-watch service.

Want eyes on your home while you're away?

We do regular documented visits with a photo report after each one, and coordinate any repairs. Get a free, custom quote.

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Before you leave (cont.)

- ☐ Photograph the home's condition before you leave for your records.

Why it matters while you're away

- Small problems, a slow leak, a failed AC, a pest issue, storm damage, become big and expensive when no one is looking for weeks.
- Many insurance policies reduce or deny claims on homes left unchecked for extended periods.
- Regular documented visits catch issues early and keep your home insurable and ready for your return.

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